While they had their own concerns about the US, some Indian officials nonetheless grew concerned about the intensifying public antipathy to the US in India. Jha worried that the longer the two countries delayed a dialogue, the harder it would be to improve relations. He urged the US to take the initiative, even if it was just with minor steps. Deputy Secretary of State John Irwin, however, pointed out that "regretfully whenever one side or the other seemed ready an event occurred which seemed calculated to create new problems."[312] Indeed, in retaliation for Gandhi's accusation-filled meeting with Keating, the US got the debt-rescheduling meeting of the India aid consortium postponed.[313] Then in India, there seemed to be a coordinated effort to stoke anti-Americanism through allegations about CIA activities in India.[314] Later in October, Gandhi tried to temper her CIA allegations. After a point, public antipathy became less useful to the leadership and more problematic. The genie, however, was out of the bottle.[315]

Kissinger often said that the US and India had had a love affair. If 1971 was the year of the breakup—and the year in which first the US and then India turned to different significant others—then 1972 was the year of the bitterness that followed the breakup. Throughout the year both sides were aware that they needed to get back to talking terms and deal with each other on a more realistic basis. But after months of vitriol and distance, it was only in November 1972 that they reached that point. And Nixon's re-election offered an opportunity for a new start.

Years later, the political counselor in the US embassy in Pakistan during the 1971 war said about South Asia that, "At that time we had a more or less neutral policy. Unfortunately it got hung up with Henry Kissinger and Richard Nixon and their globaloney."[316] That "globaloney" involving the US-USSR-China triangle had implications for the US-India-China triangle as well. India was no longer useful for the US vis-à-vis China. And India found a replacement insurance policy against China in the Soviet Union.

Given the many shifts that took place in the period from 1969 to 1972—in US-China, US-Soviet, and Sino-Soviet relations—it is perhaps understandable that the change in US-India relations during this era does not garner much attention. But developments during this period would leave a long-lasting impact on US-India relations—so much so that the mention